

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Okay. Do you agree to participate in the study according to the consent form I sent you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:07] I approve.

Speaker 1 [00:00:09] First of all, I will ask you a few demographic questions. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:14] [26-30].

Speaker 1 [00:00:16] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:20] [1-5 years].

Speaker 1 [00:00:21] [1-5 years]. Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:25] We have a cat.

Speaker 1 [00:00:26] You have a cat. Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:00:31] I live with me, my roommate, my sister.

Speaker 1 [00:00:35] What is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:00:39] I have [company] and it comes from there.

Speaker 1 [00:00:41] And how would you like me to address your partner? Partner, lover, spouse.

Speaker 2 [00:00:46] It doesn't matter. Whatever you prefer.

Speaker 1 [00:00:50] Now I'm going to ask questions in a more romantic context. Can you tell me the story of how you met and how your relationship started?

Speaker 2 [00:00:59] Sure. We were already following each other on [Social Media] for a few years. After that, of course, we saw each other all the time, but we had no communication. We knew we were from the same university. Then one day she shared a story. I liked him. They had a summer house where I used to work. After I liked him, she sent me a message. she wrote in a friendly way but I thought she wanted to communicate. Then we exchanged messages, we talked on the phone for a couple of weeks. After I returned to [City], we met face to face and that's how it started.

Speaker 1 [00:01:39] Uh-huh. So how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:01:45] 9 out of 10.

Speaker 1 [00:01:48] Uh-huh. Well, for example, when you compare it, how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships, how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:01:55] Better quality. Because in today's age, relationships are seen as more toxic or more transient, we don't have anything like that. Everything is more serious, more smooth and of a good quality. That's why I can say it's good, high quality.

Speaker 1 [00:02:13] Well, you mentioned toxicity in this answer. What kind of processes do you think create this toxicity in other relationships or what do you think are the non-toxic parts in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:02:25] For example, restriction or jealousy, since general toxicity consists of these, it was the same way in our relationships, especially in our very old young ages. We don't mind such things like what your partner wears, where they go, who they see. We have a respect for each other and we have a line, but in today's relationships, of course, not everyone has this, but this is the problem of most relationships. Who she follows on Instagram, who she sits with, who is in the environment she is in, someone is flirting with him in the place she goes to, and so on.

Speaker 1 [00:03:04] You also said in your answer that it progresses more smoothly, with better quality. Can you explain these processes a little more, can you give examples?

Speaker 2 [00:03:14] It's a little bit healthier because she is a [occupation] because she looks at the world differently, she looks at people differently and she looks at emotions differently. she is aware that everyone has a line and she was the one who taught me to respect each other's space, this actually qualified our relationship. Because she can have a life too, we don't have to be together all the time. she may have a different circle of friends and so do I. That's why we try to spend more quality time together. Because I'm working hard, he's more free, but he's preparing for his master's degree. So we both make an effort to make the time we spend together better quality and more beautiful.

Speaker 1 [00:04:01] Uh-huh. So what are the factors that make these times better quality for you, the times you spend together?

Speaker 2 [00:04:07] Well, actually, it's more like this, since I work, he's more about doing things that I like. For example, we build legos most of the time. If there is a place we like, we go to explore it. That, in fact, the most intense thing we do is to spend time at home doing nothing, chatting together or watching something. Because I'm always out during the day, we miss the time spent at home. It's usually like this.

Speaker 1 [00:04:40] Can I also ask how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:04:45] Seriously, as a proper relationship, [1-5] including this one.

Speaker 1 [00:04:50] And how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:04:58] Ten out of ten compared to the previous ones.

Speaker 1 [00:05:01] Hahaha. So do you want to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:05:06] Well, my first relationship was during my university years when I realized that I was in something real and it lasted for about [1-5] years. But of course, we were both just [16-20]

years old and she had never had such a relationship. That's why it was always about hiding it, living without people realizing it. It was very nice, it was enjoyable, but after a certain point, when she started to realize herself, she realized that she didn't actually want to be in such a relationship and at that point everything started to get worse. There was a lot of jealousy. Because I was hiding things, the interest on both sides is from the outside and there is no indication of a relationship that can protect it. That relationship wore me out a lot. Then I did a joint business with him and so on, everything started to get worse and at that point it was over. The one after that was a relationship that started from a distance but she came to [City] for me and she had lost his father. Her family was very small. She had no close friends, no one and she was very emotionally empty. I always tried to provide him with a band-aid, a psychologist, a father, but it wore me out. We started living together and at some point she pushed us further apart. Because we were two people who couldn't share anything. When I saw these things, my first relationship, for example, was very much a child relationship, it was about jealousy. The other one was about unhappiness and now everything is more balanced. I mean, not everything is going completely super, but I am aware that I am in something real compared to previous ones.

Speaker 1 [00:06:52] So what happens in the relationship that makes it feel more real?

Speaker 2 [00:06:58] Well, it's not really about the relationship but it becomes more real because of growing up and the people around you knowing about your relationship. I mean, my sister, my cousin, my very close friends, the people I care about, they all know and they don't see us as a passing thing or a fad. Or it's not like, "Oh brother, this is self-discovery, it will pass," but "Yes, they are really in a relationship and we need to support them." Everyone is aware that you have a partner when you go somewhere. This gives you a sense of being in a more real relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:07:39] So for example, do you think that the support you receive from your environment also improves the quality of your relationship with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:07:46] I think it does. Because we are a couple who are in a lot of friends, because I had this in my first relationship, you don't say anything to anyone and you try to live something, but some moments are emotional, some moments you need to hold your lover's hand somewhere and this is something that I think is very, very good for us right now.

Speaker 1 [00:08:10] So what makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:08:17] Being energetic, being joyful, feeling peaceful.

Speaker 1 [00:08:22] Uh-huh. Would you like to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:08:26] Well, I think that I am not a person who cares too much about things, who drowns in small details. The people around me think the same thing. I always look at the glass half full, it's like that in life in general; I think that my energy should always be high because I am a person who always sees the full side, whether it is work or friendship, always focuses on good things, when I get upset about small things, even if it is not about me, when you get upset, you reflect it to your partner, if there is something that cannot be solved, I think that you should not make a big deal out of it or make yourself feel more unhappy and spoil your relationship with the other party, so ruining energy, happiness and knowing that we will die at some point anyway makes the relationship feel more enjoyable.

Speaker 1 [00:09:20] So how do you think a person can understand that they are in an energetic, joyful, peaceful relationship? Would you like to give some more information about this?

Speaker 2 [00:09:30] I think this is intrinsic because not everyone can have this. For example, we work with [10-15] people, but maybe [1-5] people in the shop have this life view. But I think that there will always be unhappiness in life, there will always be problems, there will always be new problems every day. It won't always go smoothly, but if you are in a good relationship, you shouldn't let the outside factors affect it. Because your partner didn't cause this and if you don't talk and solve it together, it doesn't seem to make much sense to maintain unhappiness all the time. Can you always achieve this, you can't. For example, [Partner's Name] is someone who lives things much more inside herself and can directly express it out, whether she is happy or unhappy, she can transfer it, she says this and we always discuss this among ourselves. She says that if she is unhappy about something, she reflects on the outside and the inside, she can't pretend. I say OK, I've already accepted that part and I just don't want it to harm us. If you want me to talk, I will talk, if you want me to listen, I will listen. If you don't want to do anything, if you don't want to talk about it, you can solve it on your own. I'll wait for you. Because the other way will hurt us too.

Speaker 1 [00:10:53] So when did you feel the least energetic and joyful in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:11:01] At least when? Probably when I was unhappy. If I get caught up in little things like that, I mean little, for example, you can worry about a problem with your parents or a friend or a problem with your master's degree. But there is a problem. For example, you want to go somewhere, but then you don't feel like it, you don't worry about it there, for example. I say okay, I didn't go and I go to bed. But she internalizes it and says "Ouch" or something. At that point, my energy is drained. This is a very small detail and not a problem.

Speaker 1 [00:11:37] So what do you think makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:11:43] I think the decrease in excitement towards each other, we can't be with the same excitement every day when you see her in front of you. One, first of all, you should value yourself and do something. How can I call it, maybe it can be called preparation, I should feel better, I should prepare like this today. Always such an ongoing unhappiness, oh, we are already in a relationship, not to enter the married mode. I think these are the things. I didn't express it well.

Speaker 1 [00:12:23] Uh-huh. No, I can understand. Well, actually you touched on these a little bit, but I would like to ask you again since this is the main topic of our research. What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:38] For me, the most important thing in a relationship is excitement. The sustainability of that excitement. I mean, not getting tired of it after a certain point, not getting excited when you see her, but things like yes, we can have such a life in the future, if I buy this, she will be happy with this, or if we do something like this, I will enjoy it.

Speaker 1 [00:13:06] So what is love for you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:12] I haven't thought much about love to be honest. In general. What is love? It is to be able to share something with the other person and see your reflection. I mean, there are things that you don't like or that you are uncomfortable with yourself, for example, when you look in the mirror or when you live a life, and you don't want to see it on the other side. Even if the other person is a different individual, even if they have a different life, a different past, a different life, they should be able to give you the same reflection.

Speaker 1 [00:13:51] Uh-huh. Could you elaborate a little bit more on this part of being able to see your reflection?

Speaker 2 [00:13:56] I mean like this. For example, what I like most about [Partner's Name] is that our thoughts are very similar, I mean, our humor qualities, other than that, I probably like seven out of ten things that she likes. She likes five out of ten things that I like and we can meet at the same common point. And where we can't meet, everyone respects each other. So getting this mutual respect is actually being able to be a mirror for each other. So she doesn't want to come here, but there is a reason for that. It's not because she doesn't want me or doesn't value me. Even knowing this is actually a reflection.

Speaker 1 [00:14:45] So how important do you think love is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:49] I think it is very important. I mean, not as love (aşk) but as love (sevgi), being able to feel something is very, very important.

Speaker 1 [00:14:58] So how do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:04] How do I know? The point at which I know that [Partner's Name] loves me is this: We have such a childish way of talking. She is normally a person who speaks more harshly, more seriously, more clearly when she is in a normal mode. When she is angry, she probably doesn't love me at that moment, but if she is more cute like that, she loves me at that moment. But in general, I never doubted her love.

Speaker 1 [00:15:35] So for example, apart from this childish way of talking, are there any other behaviors or elements that make you feel that she loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:45] Of course like this. She really values the things that I like. I mean, a small thing I say resonates with her and suddenly it comes as a gift or a surprise that I didn't expect, or she doesn't want to meet with someone from my circle, but when she realizes that I want to meet at that moment, even if she is tired or doesn't want to go, she acts like let's do it anyway, it would be much better, and even if she doesn't like the things I actually like, the things I want to do, she shares them with me and this is a really big sacrifice for her.

Speaker 1 [00:16:27] So for example, do you think these kinds of sacrifices are factors that increase the quality of your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:16:33] I think they do, as long as they are done right. I mean, it's a good thing that she says let me go there to make him feel that I love him with an excitement, okay, but when she goes there, after a certain point, if she doesn't enjoy it after a certain point, if that thing we go to is actually not necessary, that is, if it affects her worse, it's bad, but as long as it's in good taste, it's good. Because she doesn't always have to feel good for me.

Speaker 1 [00:17:01] So what would you say are challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:17:07] I would say that the challenges in our relationship are that we don't live together very often at the moment. I mean, we're together all the time but we're not really living together. Other than that... I'm higher, she's more usually stable, other than that I honestly don't think we have too many difficulties. She might be thinking, she probably is thinking.

Speaker 1 [00:17:37] In this context, if it is not a sensitive issue for you, I would like to ask one more question. As you know, this is a cross-cultural study, it is also being conducted in other countries. Do you think that being in an LGBT+ relationship in [Country] brings any additional challenges or advantages for you?

Speaker 2 [00:17:57] Well, I can't say anything as an advantage, but as a challenge, we can generally say the family parts. You've reached a certain point, you've finished university, you've started your own business, you've achieved something and you're on your way to achieve something, but when you do these things, the university is already over, a job has already been found. If you don't have a master's degree plan or anything like that, what your family expects from you at some point is a relationship. To be able to see someone with you. Because when they look at you you are a normal person, you can get along with people and someone can be in your life. This is probably the hardest part. Other than that, being hesitant about whether or not to disclose it in places where you need to be professional in business life and to people you see very often. Other than that, there are not many other difficulties.

Speaker 1 [00:18:50] So, for example, do you think that the difficulties you experience in your family and work life are reflected in your relationship in this context?

Speaker 2 [00:18:58] For the moment, it is not reflected in our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:19:02] So do you and your partner fight?

Speaker 2 [00:19:06] We do.

Speaker 1 [00:19:07] Uh-huh. How often would you say these fights happen?

Speaker 2 [00:19:12] So it varies. Uh, he's just passing through here right now. How can I say, at first we didn't have so many fights. Maybe our tolerance for each other was higher. But of course, the



things that come from being intertwined and being together all the time happen even with one's siblings, but how often can I say for now? We probably fight once or twice a week.

Speaker 1 [00:19:40] So these fights... Please tell me.

Speaker 2 [00:19:43] It's not a very long fight, of course. I mean, it's not like a conflict that lasts for a day or two or an hour or two.

Speaker 1 [00:19:53] So what is this fight usually about?

Speaker 2 [00:20:00] I don't have things that I can keep in my mind because I don't like being too unhappy and depressed. But I will think about it. Because such little things are not a serious matter. For example, because we stayed at her house more often. I probably didn't put the glass in the dishwasher in the morning and I didn't occupy her space, not to occupy her space, but she has an order in her own home, okay, but I need to leave quickly and I didn't put it there out of thoughtlessness, in fact she knows this, but because she always wants me to be tidy, she suddenly sees it as a disrespect to herself, so there is an argument that comes to things like you are already doing that, you are already doing this, so I don't remember a very big argument. For example, one of our arguments was a little big, we were sitting somewhere with our friends, and we had our colleagues with us. I had a business partner with me. We had to discuss something very important with him. We had drunk a lot of alcohol. We were going to sit somewhere sweet and have a conversation. There was very loud music and at that moment I came out an hour after them, they had spent some time together, but I came in and had a cigarette and talked while we were talking and the conversation went on for a while. She got a little bored inside, like, aren't you coming or something, and we got distracted, okay, we're coming, we've been together for a long time. We said we were separated for an hour and went back inside. She said I was waiting here, you were there, you didn't think about me, I was here, and a big argument broke out. But it was an unnecessary argument. Because it wasn't something that was done because both sides didn't want each other or because they wanted to annoy each other. It was a sudden thing, and our other friend made a lot of explanations, saying that it was because of me, I'm sorry, I explained it for a long time. We did something like that there, but then we recovered after a few hours.

Speaker 1 [00:22:09] So how do you usually solve these fights?

Speaker 2 [00:22:15] when she gets angry or upset about something, she doesn't prefer to communicate. If I think there's nothing really wrong, let's wrap it up, let's talk because there's nothing really wrong, let's not hurt each other. But now I've figured it out. When I push her, when I say let's solve an issue, it's an issue for her. Even if it's not for me, because of that, I leave her alone

a little more and if she's in the room, I go to the living room and maybe I hang out there for an hour or two and then I think we come together again, I go to bed with him and I think we solve it by having a conversation like let's not sleep sulkily there again. That's what usually happens. Or we talk a little bit on that subject. We apologize to each other. Sometimes we don't apologize, we say that I was right, but okay, yes, I am sure of my love, this is a problem for us because there is nothing big, and it is solved.

Speaker 1 [00:23:21] So apart from these behaviors, what do you think are the other ways to maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:23:29] Uh, right now it's a very bumpy time for both of us. For me it's settling down, growing up, for her it's graduate school. That's why both of our lives are difficult, so it's inevitably reflected, and I think that probably when she gets her master's degree, when she starts to take clearer steps about her life, when things become clearer, her perspective will change because some of the things she is stuck on in her head will go away. For me, it's the same a little bit more, especially after I get through this year, the quality of life will increase a little bit more in every sense, and at this point, the things I'm stuck on will start to decrease. Because these are the things that affect us the most, external factors, not things about us. I think the difficulties of life are the things that we reflect to each other like you are with me and you have to bear me.

Speaker 1 [00:24:26] So how do you think these external factors reflect on your relationship or if there is a bad reflection, how do you try to prevent them?

Speaker 2 [00:24:36] Well, for example, she has a really high stress right now. Well, there is an exam on the second day of the month, it will be announced. Then there is a school placement period and so on. These are like this, I always try to instill in her that I am always with her, that there is no limit to everything I can do financially and emotionally, that I will do everything I can for her and that she can succeed, but since she looks at it more realistically, it may not work out. There is this part too. I try not to get too much into her space because she says I should act with this in mind, because she never likes that. I mean, she says yes you can, you can help me financially, you can help me spiritually, but I'm not even sure if I want to go yet and you are the one who can solve it. So by just listening to what she thinks, not commenting anymore and helping her where she wants to go. On my side, when I have a problem, when I have something on my mind, she is also very valuable to me, for example, I am very interested in what she says. I already consult a lot of things because of her [degree program]. I mean, we discuss how something that happens to me will affect me, how I should react, so I don't reflect the things that come from external factors even to myself, so I don't reflect them to her too much, but when I do, we don't have a fight with her anyway. She directly tells me what I need to do, where I am doing what I am doing and we deal with that issue. But on her side, like I said, I listen, if there is something I want to say, I say it if she wants me to, and we are actually trying to learn not to turn it into a fight right now. Because we both care,

we both want to help each other and we both want to do good for each other, but without realizing it, we can say things that we offend each other.

Speaker 1 [00:26:40] So would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:26:46] Yes, I would say so.

Speaker 1 [00:26:47] Uh-huh. Would you like to elaborate a little bit on why you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:26:53] Well, as I said at the beginning, I am aware that I am in a safe relationship. I have nothing to suspect. I have someone who cares about me and always supports me to be successful, for example, I had very intense periods at work. Last year was much more intense. She was with me during that period too. I had to work very long hours. We didn't see each other for a few days. Even at those points. Yes, she said "it is already such a process for you and I am with you, work as you want, do what you want, don't think about me. I'm here, there's no problem" so generally for me, trust is very important, and as I said, peace is very important, and maybe we won't be able to achieve this peace completely, but when things fall into place, it will come with us. Because we have no worries about each other.

Speaker 1 [00:27:44] Uh-huh. Well, for example, you mentioned that she supports you to be successful. I mean, how has this relationship affected you in terms of achieving your goals or organizing your daily life?

Speaker 2 [00:28:01] Well, again, since she is studying [degree program], I consult her on many things because I have [10-15] employees on average and I have to deal with someone's problems every day and I start to feel inadequate at these points and I always get support from her like this. For example, I call her, something like this happened, this person is actually such and such a person, but what can I do in such and such a reaction? She tells me what I need to do. These really have a good effect. For example, during the earthquake... We were in [City] during the earthquake. I was [1-5] years old at the time, we had experienced the earthquake there. My aunt was trapped in the rubble, but of course we were not aware of it. We came to [City] from there. I was probably traumatized there, but I am not conscious of it because I don't remember it, I only have as much as my father told me. There were points during the earthquake when it felt like I was looking at the world through my eyes and everything was a simulation. I would say something like this for 5 minutes, 6 minutes, as if we were not alive right now, even if I break this, nothing will change because I feel like we are in a game, and this happened a few times after the earthquake. She talked to me thinking that it might be my earthquake trauma and then when I realized it, I thought it might really be related to that. It was good for me at that point. You see, because she is a very

researcher, a very knowledgeable person in many things, she makes such differences in my life. That part gives me joy and peace.

Speaker 1 [00:29:43] So did this relationship change you?

Speaker 2 [00:29:47] Yes, it changed my perspective.

Speaker 1 [00:29:49] And in what way do you think it changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:29:53] In what way? Well, it changed the way I communicate with people. Apart from that, it changed my ideals... I was always a success-oriented person, but it made me realize that I have the power to do something. It made me realize that I can be stronger. How else did it change me? It showed me that I can have an individual space. Because I had no individuality in my previous relationships. I mean, it was always, I need to be with him, with him, with him. Sunday is very important. If I'm not with him, I can't spend it with my family. Because I never saw him during the week. There were these things, but there is nothing like that now. For example, I live apart from my family, they will come. At first I was always thinking, they will come on Sunday, but what should I do? I need to meet her, for example. What should we do if my parents are coming? She said "Of course you should. Are you crazy? That's great, your parents are coming". I said, "Oh, yeah," so it's not just about that. I mean, yes, I have to make time for certain things, but there are also things I have to do. It's not all about her. For example, it made me realize that.

Speaker 1 [00:31:11] And do you think your partner changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:31:17] I think she changed. That's what she thinks anyway, or I think so when she talks to me. I think I softened her a little bit more. I think her perspective, her level of tolerance for people has increased a little more.

Speaker 1 [00:31:36] So would you like to explain the softening part a little more?

Speaker 2 [00:31:41] Like this. How can I put it? She was much more pointed, much more like that, much more like to write people off more easily, finishing them more easily and ok, let them do it a little bit, but then, for example, she says now that she has changed more with me because I have become more tolerant of some things, for example, she couldn't tolerate most of the things I did at first, but she started to say, yes, this may be the normal.

Speaker 1 [00:32:22] So do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:32:26] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:32:27] Can you explain a little bit why you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:32:31] Well, like I said, the safe part is that this relationship doesn't end very easily. I think there has to be something serious or there has to be a real difference of opinion. That's the first safe part, and secondly I never had any doubt that she would cheat or anything like that. I never felt anything like that about her. Other than that, I know there is a safe haven.

Speaker 1 [00:33:05] Would you like to elaborate a little bit more on the part that I know there is a safe haven, for example, could you give an example here?

Speaker 2 [00:33:12] I mean, I can go directly to her and tell her about the things I'm worried about, or the problems I'm having with my work, the problems I'm having with my life, the points where I'm overwhelmed. She listens to me very well, she sits down and listens to me seriously, and she always shows me a way to deal with it. So when I tell her, will she hold it over me? No, she won't. She will only listen to me and guide me as much as I want, as much as I allow, so I am aware of that.

Speaker 1 [00:33:46] Yes, I'm going to share a screen with you now, can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:33:58] Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:33:59] If I asked you that my partner usually really listens to me, what would you say on a scale of 1 not true at all to 9 completely true?

Speaker 2 [00:34:10] 8.

Speaker 1 [00:34:11] 8. And if I asked you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, how would you rate on a scale of 1 not at all true to 9 completely true?

Speaker 2 [00:34:28] 8.

Speaker 1 [00:34:34] 8. Okay. Can I ask you why you answered 8 for our first item, my partner usually really listens to me?

Speaker 2 [00:34:43] Because you tell someone something, you know, you tell some things to a few people and then you think about it again and you tell it with the same feeling. But she sometimes says that I already explained this. I deducted one point for that because I actually thought of it again with that excitement and I wanted to say it. Other than that, when I tell something serious, she always listens, but if it's something unnecessary, she prefers to listen. She says there is no need to tell me about it. Probably for me, she might have given me two or three points. Actually, I am listening to her, but because I am thinking about a lot of things in my head, it can be presented as if she is not listening.

Speaker 1 [00:35:30] Uh-huh. So can you give concrete examples of this? Like when she listens or when she doesn't listen?

Speaker 2 [00:35:40] Uh, if it's something interesting. Ok, she definitely listens, if I tell her something about people she doesn't like, she says "Oh, never mind". If it's something I've told before or something I've mentioned a little bit, she'd rather not listen. But she always listens to really important things that I care about.

Speaker 1 [00:36:05] Uh-huh. And why did you answer eight and not seven or nine?

Speaker 2 [00:36:12] Because she usually listens, so there is a one point not listening part. Because probably 90% of what I tell her is already important, 10% may or may not be listened. Because there is nothing anyway. Because in general she listens. I mean, it's like this, it's not that I'm explaining something, if we are in an environment, when I talk about something, she takes it directly. So I didn't necessarily interpret it as sitting across from each other and telling something, listening to something.

Speaker 1 [00:36:40] Can I ask why you answered 8 for our other item, my partner is usually sensitive to my needs?

Speaker 2 [00:36:50] Uh, she really analyzes very well what I want. She always tries to do things related to it, to fulfill it. But the one point I deducted, let me say it applies to the house. I like to play games and stuff and I want to spend time with her because I'm already working very hard, but I also want to play Playstation a little bit, so I took her to the store, for example, so that I could play for an hour when I go out instead of doing stuff at home. If I want to spend the time I could spend with her on something else, that's where the point I broke is. I mean, don't do that, we are already getting together, let me be the one you need in that part. But other than that, most of the things I want, for example, let's go there, okay, if you like that place, let's be there, let's make lego. Okay, you like this, let's do it and I like this, so I broke a point there.

Speaker 1 [00:37:53] Uh-huh. So why did you answer eight and not seven or nine, similarly?

Speaker 2 [00:37:57] I deducted one because she doesn't allow all my needs, especially the game kind of things that I want individually. The reason I didn't give her a seven is because she really cares and does everything that I really want.

Speaker 1 [00:38:13] I hope you don't mind them asking and if it would be too sensitive for you to share please feel free to say so. But I also wanted to know about your physical makeup as a couple, how often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker 2 [00:38:29] Less these days. Less these days. Probably less for [1-5 months]. Why is that? Partly because of my busyness. Secondly, because of too many intense collective meetings, so that we are less and less with each other. We see each other less often, or when we do, we are both very tired. A little bit of that healthy relationship makes you gain weight thing, it made us gain a little bit of weight and we were very frustrated because of that, and even we talk about it from time to time, she does that too. I think there is also such a pushing thing, so it may be something like we feel like we are forcing ourselves to do this and we cannot do it.

Speaker 1 [00:39:25] So how satisfied are you with your sexual life?

Speaker 2 [00:39:31] No problem for me, 8, 8.

Speaker 1 [00:39:35] Why do you say that...?

Speaker 2 [00:39:37] Hah, I was just about to say that. In these kinds of relationships, since it is already difficult to establish a proper relationship, as you know because you have researched it, in this country, people always see it as sexuality, especially men, because it is always interpreted as something that is sexualized and that it is interpreted as just having sexual intercourse and not continuing it, rather than establishing a relationship. I mean, when you open up to someone or if they don't know you at all, there are people that even we judge from the outside in this way. It's just for that, they don't even have a real relationship. But it's not like that for me. In normal relationships, such as a normal relationship, this kind of sexual decrease in normal relationships, the decrease in sexuality is also very normal, and since I see these as very normal, ok, this is a transition period. Maybe we don't feel ready for this right now. So maybe we are not in that mode. The thoughts in our head may be getting in the way of this. I mean, it's not about that, it's about the busyness of work, the rush of life, the thing of getting somewhere, you're already tired, and when your head is tired, it's like you can't give yourself to anything. So it doesn't strike me as absurd or anything. So I don't see it as a problem?

Speaker 1 [00:41:06] So how important do you think sexuality is in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:41:11] I think it is very important for a healthy relationship. I don't think about it too much because it is a transitional period, but when we spread it to a normal whole, it must be. Because I also think it is something that brings people closer to each other, especially like this. It is also something that makes you realize that you feel something for that person.

Speaker 1 [00:41:39] Well, for example, in your answers you mentioned healthy relationships and proper relationships. What do you think are the elements that make up these relationships? Do you think we can make a comment like a healthy relationship or a proper relationship or healthy relationships are high quality relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:41:57] We can actually say that healthy relationships are high quality relationships. It overlaps with each other, but what I mean by a healthy relationship is, for example, she is going to graduate school and I don't have a thought in my mind like let's continue until she goes and then we'll move on somehow. She's going to go for a year and for me it means a winter and a summer. Ok, I can plan my life in this way anyway, and in her absence we can concentrate more on work and grow it and live something more comfortable when she comes. Being able to plan for the future with her. Not having a random person in my head. To be able to say that when she comes into the same house, yes, we can share and we will really enjoy it, in fact, I can say that I can look at things in a serious way, but at the same time I can be sure of her love, I can be sure of my love. So if you have a few thoughts in your mind, this person might not love me, they might be with me for this



reason. If there is a thought that she will break up with me when she goes there anyway, this is not a healthy relationship, or if you are constantly fantasizing in your own head, if the other person is constantly fantasizing about you, I think this is not a healthy relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:43:10] Hmm. So for example, what do you think distinguishes a healthy relationship and a high quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:43:19] A healthy relationship can be in many relationships. A monotonous relationship, a high quality relationship, or a relationship at a normal level, but a high quality relationship can be that the excitement is always alive. So what I mean by high quality, when I say that the excitement stays alive, I mean that both parties have a really high level of love for each other. I mean, there are people like that around me. I mean, they have had children, but they are still very attentive to each other. When they see each other or somewhere, they always have a thought in their head about him, that's what she likes. Maybe [6-10] years have passed since the relationship, but I can interpret it as thinking that there is still someone there, that she is not an individual who is at home, but someone she really cares about in his life.

Speaker 1 [00:44:17] Now I'm going to share a screen with you again. If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general, which of the following options would you choose?

Speaker 2 [00:44:35] Whatever I say will be a question now. I can say very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:44:44] Okay. So how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? On a scale of 0 being not satisfied at all and 10 being completely satisfied, how would you rate it?

Speaker 2 [00:44:55] 8.

Speaker 1 [00:44:57] 8. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:45:01] Why not 7? Why not 10?

Speaker 1 [00:45:06] Ahahah yes. Can I ask you first of all why you answered 8?

Speaker 2 [00:45:10] Why eight? I'm satisfied. I mean satisfied enough. It's not something that I can say, oh, I'm very satisfied, it's great because we still have a lot to accomplish. I mean, there are many points where we haven't seen each other yet. I don't know what it will be like, for example, when she really enters a business life, when she is in that intensity, I don't know, for example, how we will look at each other, how we will have time for each other, or what will be the quality of the time we spend together, when we grow up in the future or in a few years, I'm going to be [26-30] years old in about [1-5] days here, and at that point, when we are with the people around us, because there will be a year apart and we will be in different places. Maybe we will have other partnerships and other friends here. When she comes back, will her mindset there change again? Will she be looking for the same thing here? I mean, will she still be satisfied with this environment? There are of course these kinds of things. So of course it is not possible to say that everything is completely perfect. For the moment, I am satisfied because there is nothing that upsets me, hurts me or makes me unhappy. So I'm in a good mood. My life is in a certain order. I enjoy the things I do with her, so I can't say I'm very satisfied, but I'm okay, it's good.

Speaker 1 [00:46:48] Can I also ask why you answered eight and not seven or nine?

Speaker 2 [00:46:55] Why did I answer 8? I was expecting that but I didn't think about it. Well, when I look at it in terms of percentage, eighty is positive, it's good. I think there must be twenty difficult. That's why. You can't even be 100% satisfied with yourself. You can't be happy with your mom or dad either. That's why 20 percent of the time there are points where we don't like each other.

Speaker 1 [00:47:28] So did this relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:47:34] I mean, even if it didn't meet all of my expectations, yes, it met some of them, the part that didn't meet my expectations was that in my previous relationship I was with someone who was very focused on unhappiness, because she was someone who was never satisfied with anything, who never saw the good side of life, so when I came to this relationship, I was always open to her at first. I can't do it with someone who is always unhappy. Because what keeps me going in life or what I have hope for is that I look at everything in a good way. I mean, I enjoy things. That's why I can't sustain this for a long time, I tried, but I realized that I'm not a psychologist for a person. I've moved too far away from my happiness. So we can overcome things together. At first, she even internalized it so much that at first she didn't even reflect the things she was unhappy about. But then gradually, of course, people can continue like that up to a certain point, but after all, you are a human being and there are realities inside you. These started to emerge. Actually, yes, I started to see that when she wears something, she can wear it for a very long time. That's why I started to realize that she was upset about what I said, for example, this is not a problem, and that she was more upset about it because I said this is not a problem. That's why. What was the question?

Speaker 1 [00:49:12] Did your relationship fulfill all your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:49:14] Hah, exactly, okay. Let's talk about that. One, at a certain point these things started to happen and it was like, yes, you had a very energetic, very happy person in front of you. Up to a certain point, but I also said that yes, it was like that because you said that at the beginning. But it didn't make her a bad person or a person who was always unhappy. It's a transition period right now and that's why it's like this. That's why I said, yes, she realizes that when she is unhappy, I feel sad too and she tries to fix it. That's why my expectations really matched compared to the relationships I had in the past. Because there is someone who also knows the reason for her unhappiness. So there is no one rising for nothing. This was already my expectation. To live something by being aware of something.

Speaker 1 [00:50:06] Thank you very much. We are about to finish now, but I would like to summarize what I have talked about in the last hour, just in case there are any mistakes or if there is anything you want to add. First of all, we started with demographic questions. You said that you are [26-30] years old, you have been in a relationship for [1-5 years] you have a cat. You mentioned that your main source of income is [occupation]. You said that your relationship started on [Social Media] and then evolved into a face-to-face relationship after the conversations there. You said that compared to your friends' relationships, you find your relationship to be of higher quality because the relationships around you are more toxic, more ephemeral. You said that your own relationships were more serious, of higher quality, with less jealousy and less restriction and giving each other space. Compared to your past romantic relationships, you said that in your first relationship there was a lot of hiding from people and in the other one there was a lot of emotional emptiness, but this relationship is more balanced. When we asked you what makes a relationship of high quality for you, you mentioned energy, being peaceful, enjoyable, not letting your excitement for each other diminish and the importance of taking care and preparing for it. Again, when we asked you about the most important things, you mentioned excitement. When we asked you what love is according to you, you answered to be able to share something with the other person and to see your reflection in them. In the reflection part, you explained it with being able to meet at a common point, getting mutual respect and you said that love is important but love is more important, it is something built on love. When we asked you how you can tell if your partner loves you, you stated that it is the childish way of talking, you mentioned that the difficulties in your relationship are the inability to live together frequently and the family parts, in the LGBT context. You said that when you fight with your partner, it happens about once or twice a week, usually when you stay at his/her house, such as leaving glasses at work, but that you resolve these situations by talking. In terms of ways to maintain your relationship, you talked about being there for him, giving him that space, being supportive. You said that this relationship was good for you and made you feel that you had someone you could trust, someone who supported you to be successful. You said that this relationship changed you, like communicating with people or making you realize that you have the power to do something or that you can have an individual space. You also said that your partner changed, became softer or more tolerant. You said that you felt safe in

this relationship. You emphasized that you have a place of refuge. When asked if my partner usually listens to me, you answered 8. You said that he/she listens if it is interesting, but sometimes he/she doesn't listen to people he/she doesn't like or when it is an uninteresting topic. You also said that your partner is usually sensitive to your needs, answering 8. You said that he/she analyzes what you want well. You said that your sex life was less frequent during this period but that you were generally satisfied. With an answer of 8 out of 10, you said it was good. You stated that sexual life is important for a healthy relationship and that it is an element that brings people closer. When we asked you about your satisfaction in your relationship, you answered that you were very satisfied and again you indicated a satisfaction scale range of 8. You emphasized that there are still things you need to complete. Likewise, you said that this relationship has its difficult aspects, but mostly you said that this relationship meets your expectations. Is there anything you would like to add or change?

Speaker 2 [00:54:21] No. Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:54:22] Okay. Thank you very much again. Now before we finish, I would like to talk to you about how we are going to handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as transparent as ethically possible and therefore we would like to know which data sharing option is most suitable for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain information that can identify you. This way, our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. anonymized. There is a small chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down who they believe you are among their colleagues. But I would like to reiterate that no sensitive information will be shared and all information will be shared in a de-identified, anonymous way. Which of these two options would you prefer?

Speaker 2 [00:55:31] The second one, no problem.

Speaker 1 [00:55:34] Okay. Thank you very much again. That's the end of our interview. We believe that your perspective and your input is very valuable for this project. I would like you to know that this project is also being carried out in other countries like Brazil, Netherlands, France, America. Because we really believe that your perspective will make a very valuable contribution to this intercultural project. Once again, thank you very much for your time. In the meantime, I am going to send you a link to a survey, which will take about ten minutes, and I will give you a participant code to fill out this survey. I will ask you to enter this participant code where it asks for your name. This way we will keep your data anonymous. Thank you very much again. I wish you happiness.

Speaker 2 [00:56:19] You're welcome, thank you.